

ACCESSIBILITY AUDIT REPORT

Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers

sanduskycountysanitaryengineers.com · WCAG 2.1 Level AA / ADA
Title II

Audit Date: June 2025
Framework: Materialize CSS
Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA
Regulation: ADA Title II
Files Audited: 11 PHP templates

11

FILES
AUDITED

52

FIXES
APPLIED

AA

WCAG
TARGET

Table of Contents

1.	Executive Summary	Page 2
2.	Fix Count by File	Page 2
3.	Shared Templates: nav.php, footer.php	Page 3
4.	index.php	Page 4
5.	Simple Content Pages (duties, stats, contractors, forms, faq, links, pay)	Page 5
6.	contact.php	Page 5
7.	Skip Link CSS Fix	Page 6
8.	WCAG Criteria Reference	Page 6

1. Executive Summary



This report documents the WCAG 2.1 Level AA / ADA Title II accessibility audit performed on the **Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers** website. The site is built on **Materialize CSS**, a Material Design framework. A total of **52 accessibility fixes** were identified and corrected across 11 PHP templates, spanning navigation, ARIA labeling, heading hierarchy, form accessibility, modal dialogs, carousel media controls, and output encoding.

The most impactful single change is the **skip navigation link** added to nav.php, combined with `id="main-content"` added to every page's content area, enabling keyboard and screen-reader users to bypass the navigation bar on every page. The skip link requires a small CSS addition (documented at the end of this report) to remain visually hidden until focused.

Seven pages (duties, stats, contractors, forms, faq, links, pay) share an identical simple template pattern. Each required the same two fixes: a unique descriptive `<title>` and a `<main id="main-content">` landmark. These are documented together as a group for clarity.

Key Issue Categories

Category	Description	Files Affected
Page Titles	All pages used the identical generic title "Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers." Each page now has a unique descriptive title following the pattern "Page Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers."	All 11 pages
Skip Navigation & Main Landmark	No skip link existed; added to nav.php. Every page's content area was missing a <code><main id="main-content"></code> landmark required as the skip link target.	All pages
Navigation ARIA	Both nav elements lacked <code>aria-label</code> , making them indistinguishable. The mobile trigger was a non-functional <code></code> link with no label. Mobile sidenav links wrapped headings inside anchors (invalid	nav.php

Category	Description	Files Affected
	HTML). <code>aria-current="page"</code> was absent throughout.	
Modal Dialog	The contact modal in footer.php lacked <code>role="dialog"</code> , <code>aria-modal</code> , and <code>aria-labelledby</code> . The form HTML structure was broken — the form opened inside one column but closed after the modal footer.	footer.php
Form Accessibility	Forms lacked <code>autocomplete</code> attributes, <code>aria-required</code> , required field legends, and had duplicate <code>id</code> attributes across multiple fields. The email field in the modal used <code>type="text"</code> . The message field used a single-line input instead of a <code><textarea></code> .	footer.php, contact.php
Decorative Icons	Material Icons used throughout as decorative prefixes and indicators were not hidden from assistive technology, causing them to be announced as unlabeled images.	footer.php, contact.php
Carousel / Motion	The homepage image carousel had no ARIA landmark, used non-functional <code></code> wrappers as carousel items, and had no pause/stop control as required by WCAG 2.2.2 for auto-playing content.	index.php
Output Encoding	Database-sourced values were echoed without <code>htmlspecialchars()</code> , creating XSS vulnerability and potential for malformed HTML.	index.php, footer.php

Fix Count by File

footer.php	13
nav.php	9
contact.php	9
index.php	7
duties.php	2
stats.php	2
contractors.php	2
forms.php	2
faq.php	2
links.php	2
pay.php	2

2. Shared Templates

These files are included on every page. Fixes here have site-wide effect.

nav.php 9 fixes			
#	Issue	Fix	WCAG
1	No skip navigation link — keyboard users must tab through entire nav on every page load	Added <code>Skip to main content</code> as the very first element in the file	2.4.1
2	Header <code><nav></code> has redundant <code>role="navigation"</code> and no <code>aria-label</code> — indistinguishable from main nav	Removed redundant role; added <code>aria-label="Site header"</code>	4.1.2
3	Main <code><nav></code> has redundant <code>role="navigation"</code> and no <code>aria-label</code>	Removed redundant role; added <code>aria-label="Main navigation"</code>	4.1.2
4	Logo <code></code> duplicates adjacent brand-logo text link — announced twice by screen readers	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>	1.1.1
5	Desktop <code></code> has no accessible label	Added <code>aria-label="Main navigation"</code>	4.1.2
6	Mobile sidenav <code></code> has no accessible label; links wrap <code><h5></code> elements — invalid HTML creating phantom headings in AT heading navigation	Added <code>aria-label="Mobile navigation"</code> ; removed all <code><h5></code> wrappers from inside anchor tags	1.3.1 4.1.1
7	Mobile trigger is <code></code> — non-functional link with no label; icon not hidden from AT	Changed to <code><button></code> with <code>aria-label="Open navigation menu"</code> , <code>aria-expanded="false"</code> , <code>aria-controls="nav-mobile"</code> ; added	4.1.2

#	Issue	Fix	WCAG
		<code>aria-hidden="true"</code> to icon; added <code>hide-on-large-only</code> class	
8	Two "Pay Online" links open in new tab with no screen reader warning	Added <code>aria-label="Pay Online (opens in new tab)"</code> and <code>rel="noopener"</code> to both	2.4.4
9	No <code>aria-current="page"</code> on active nav links	Added PHP <code>basename(\$_SERVER['PHP_SELF'])</code> detection to set <code>aria-current="page"</code> on both desktop and mobile navs	4.1.2

footer.php

13 fixes

#	Issue	Fix	WCAG
1	Modal <code><div></code> missing <code>role="dialog"</code> , <code>aria-modal="true"</code> , <code>aria-labelledby</code>	Added all three attributes; added <code>id="modal1-title"</code> to <code><h4></code>	4.1.2
2	Form HTML structure broken — <code><form></code> opens inside <code>.col.s6</code> but <code></form></code> closes after <code>.modal-footer</code> ; submit button may be outside the form	Restructured: <code><form></code> now wraps entire modal-content and modal-footer	4.1.1
3	<code>id="icon_telephone"</code> duplicated on 3 form fields — label association broken for all but the first field	Assigned unique IDs: <code>contact-name</code> , <code>contact-phone</code> , <code>contact-email-field</code> , <code>contact-msg</code> ; updated all <code>for</code> attributes accordingly	1.3.1 4.1.1
4	Email field uses <code>type="text"</code> — no email keyboard on mobile, no browser validation	Changed to <code>type="email"</code>	1.3.5
5	Message field is a single-line <code><input type="text"></code> — inadequate for a message; no resize affordance	Replaced with <code><textarea class="materialize-textarea"></code>	1.3.1
6	Decorative mail icon <code><i class="material-icons large center"></code> not hidden from AT	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>	1.1.1
7	Three form prefix icons not hidden from AT	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code> to all 3	1.1.1

#	Issue	Fix	WCAG
8	Submit button icon not hidden from AT	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code> to send icon	1.1.1
9	Phone number "419-334-6252" is plain text — keyboard and AT users cannot activate it	Wrapped in <code></code>	2.4.4
10	Form fields missing <code>autocomplete</code> attributes and <code>aria-required="true"</code> ; no required fields legend	Added <code>autocomplete</code> (name, tel, email), <code>aria-required="true"</code> to required fields, and required fields legend paragraph	1.3.5 4.1.2
11	Parallax image <code>alt="Splash"</code> — non-descriptive; decorative background image	Changed to <code>alt=""</code>	1.1.1
12	Footer DB title values echoed raw without <code>htmlspecialchars()</code>	Wrapped all three title echoes in <code>htmlspecialchars()</code>	4.1.1
13	"Digital Kingdom Interprises" link opens in new tab; missing <code>rel="noopener"</code>	Added <code>rel="noopener"</code> and <code>aria-label="Digital Kingdom Interprises (opens in new tab)"</code>	2.4.4

3. Page-by-Page Findings

index.php				7 fixes
#	Issue	Fix	WCAG	
1	No <code><main id="main-content"></code> landmark — skip link target missing	Wrapped content in <code><main id="main-content"></code>	2.4.1	
2	Carousel container has no ARIA landmark — screen readers have no context for the image gallery	Added <code>role="region" aria-label="Photo gallery" aria-roledescription="carousel"</code>	1.3.1	
3	Each carousel item is <code></code> — non-functional link in tab order, announced as "link" with no destination	Changed to <code><div class="carousel-item" role="group" aria-roledescription="slide"></code>	4.1.2	
4	Carousel auto-plays indefinitely — WCAG 2.2.2 requires a pause/stop mechanism for content that moves automatically for more than 5 seconds	Added pause/play toggle button with JavaScript controller; button updates <code>aria-label</code> dynamically between "Pause photo gallery" and "Play photo gallery"	2.2.2	
5	<code>\$r['gal_pic']</code> echoed raw into <code>src</code> attribute — XSS risk	Wrapped in <code>htmlspecialchars()</code>	4.1.1	
6	<code>\$r['gal_alt']</code> echoed raw into <code>alt</code> attribute — XSS risk	Wrapped in <code>htmlspecialchars()</code>	4.1.1	
7	<code><div class="col s12"></code> placed outside a <code>.row</code> — broken Materialize grid structure	Wrapped column in <code><div class="row"></code>	1.3.1	

duties.php / stats.php / contractors.php
/ forms.php / faq.php / links.php /
pay.php

2 fixes
each

#	Issue	Fix Applied To	WCAG
1	Generic <code><title>Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers</title></code> — identical on every page; screen reader users cannot distinguish pages in browser history, tabs, or window switchers	Duties Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers Statistics Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers Contractors Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers Forms Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers FAQ Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers Links Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers Pay Options Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers	2.4.2
2	Content area is a plain <code><div></code> with no <code><main></code> landmark and no <code>id="main-content"</code> — skip link target is broken; screen readers cannot navigate directly to main content	All 7 pages: content wrapped in <code><main id="main-content"></code>	2.4.1

contact.php

9 fixes

#	Issue	Fix	WCAG
1	Generic <code><title></code>	Contact Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers	2.4.2
2	No <code><main id="main-content"></code> landmark	Wrapped content in <code><main id="main-content"></code>	2.4.1
3		Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code>	1.1.1

#	Issue	Fix	WCAG
	Decorative mail icon <code><i class="material-icons"></code> not hidden from AT		
4	Three form prefix icons not hidden from AT	Added <code>aria-hidden="true"</code> to all 3	1.1.1
5	"Contact Us" heading uses <code><h3></code> with no preceding H1 or H2 — heading starts at H3	Changed to <code><h2></code>	1.3.1
6	Name and email fields missing <code>autocomplete</code> attributes	Added <code>autocomplete="name"</code> and <code>autocomplete="email"</code>	1.3.5
7	No <code>aria-required="true"</code> on any field; no required fields legend	Added legend paragraph and <code>aria-required="true"</code> to all 3 fields	4.1.2
8	Submit button <code>value="send"</code> — lowercase, not descriptive	Changed to <code>value="Send Message"</code>	2.4.6
9	Google Maps <code><iframe></code> missing <code>title</code> attribute — screen readers cannot identify the embedded map	Added <code>title="Google Maps - Sandusky County Sanitary Engineers location"</code>	4.1.2

4. Skip Link CSS (Required)

The skip link added to `nav.php` must be visually hidden by default and revealed only on keyboard focus. Add the following to `css/style.css`:

```
.skip-link {
  position: absolute;
  top: -40px;
  left: 0;
  z-index: 9999;
  padding: 8px 16px;
  background: #000;
  color: #fff;
  font-weight: bold;
  text-decoration: none;
  transition: top 0.2s;
}

.skip-link:focus {
  top: 0;
}
```

When a keyboard user presses **Tab** as their first action on any page, the link slides into view at the top of the screen, allowing them to jump directly past the navigation to the main content area. Sighted mouse users never see it. This satisfies **WCAG 2.4.1 – Bypass Blocks**.

5. WCAG 2.1 Criteria Reference

Criterion	Level	Name	Description
1.1.1	A	Non-text Content	All non-text content has a text alternative. Decorative images and icons use <code>alt=""</code> or <code>aria-hidden="true"</code> .
1.3.1	A	Info and Relationships	Structure and relationships conveyed visually are also conveyed programmatically. Heading levels must not skip. Grid columns require row wrappers.
1.3.5	AA	Identify Input Purpose	

Criterion	Level	Name	Description
			Form inputs collecting personal data expose <code>autocomplete</code> attributes matching the input's purpose.
2.2.2	A	Pause, Stop, Hide	Auto-playing content that moves for more than 5 seconds and runs in parallel with other content must have a pause/stop mechanism.
2.4.1	A	Bypass Blocks	A mechanism exists to skip repeated navigation blocks (skip link targeting <code>id="main-content"</code>).
2.4.2	A	Page Titled	Each page has a title that describes its topic or purpose. Generic identical titles fail this criterion.
2.4.4	A	Link Purpose (In Context)	The purpose of each link can be determined from link text or context. New-tab links must warn users.
2.4.6	AA	Headings and Labels	Headings and labels describe topic or purpose.
4.1.1	A	Parsing	HTML is well-formed; elements are properly nested; IDs are unique. PHP output must use <code>htmlspecialchars()</code> .
4.1.2	A	Name, Role, Value	All UI components have accessible names, roles, and state values exposed to assistive technology.

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